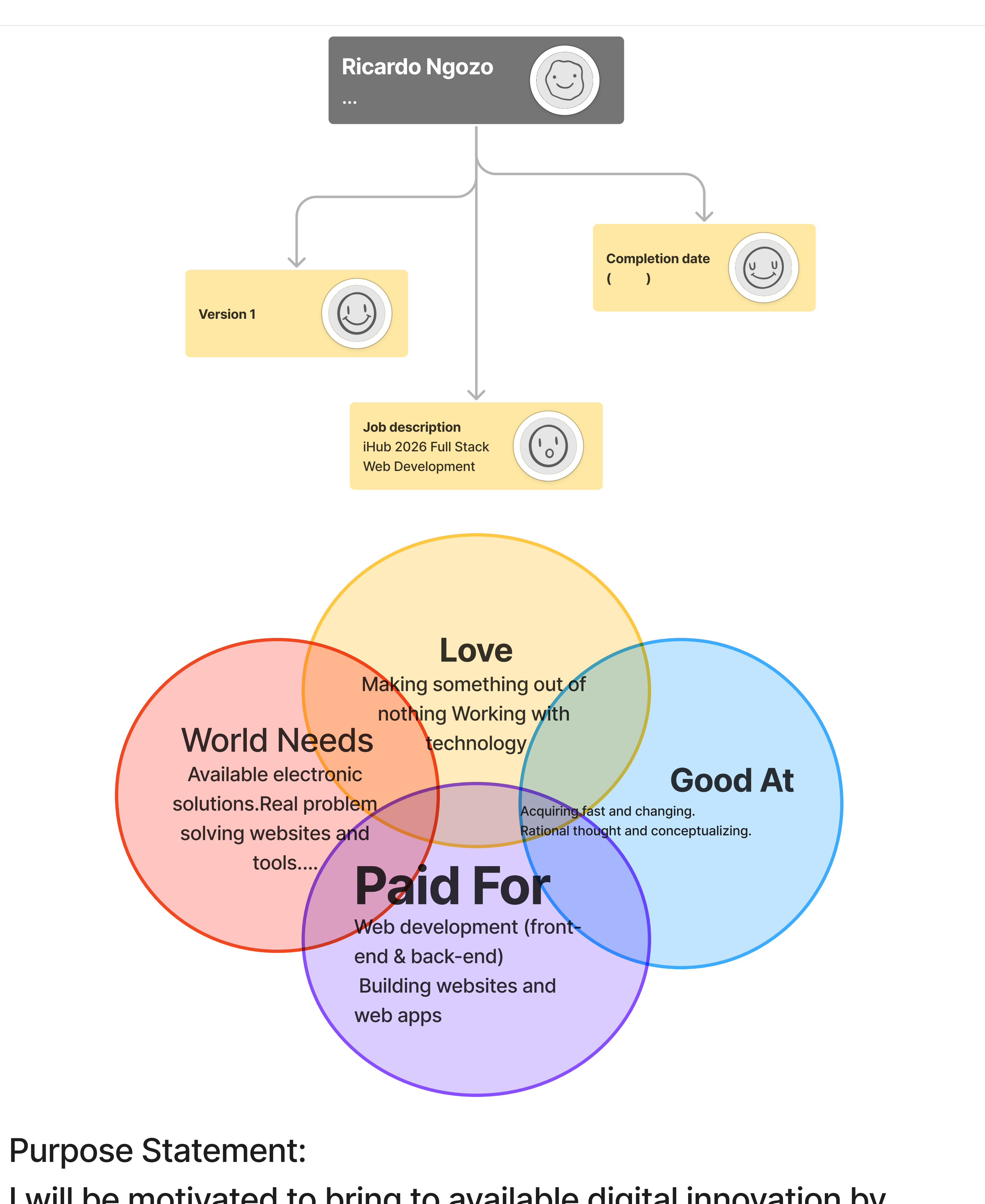
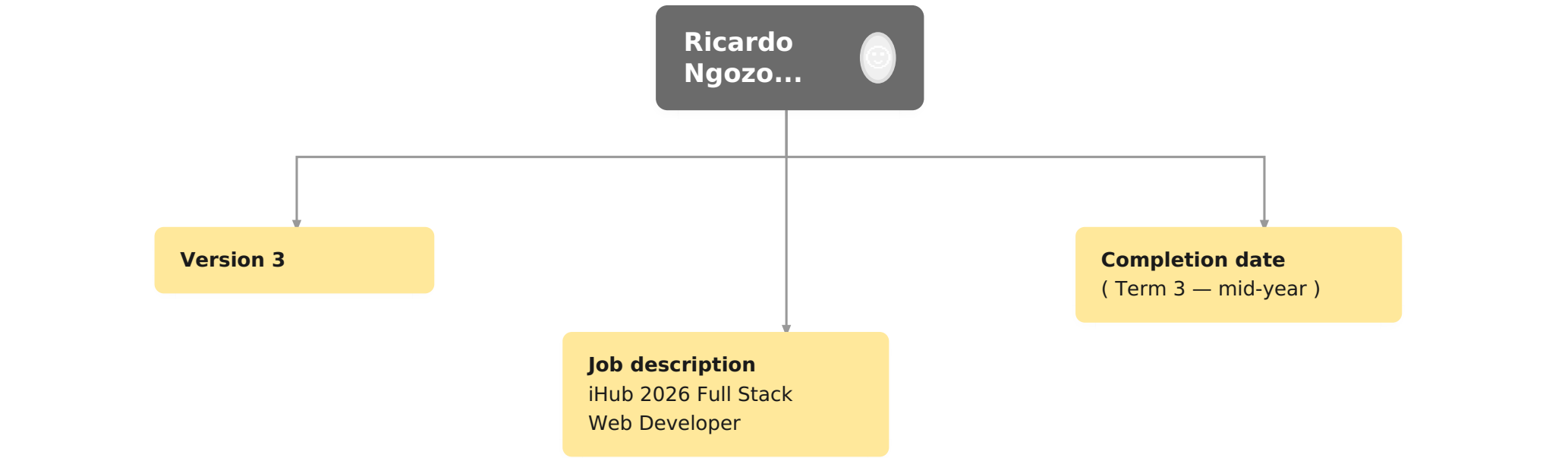




Term 3 Check-In Blueprint



Mid-Year Reflection

This page updates — it does not replace — Versions 1 and 2 above. It answers the question the Blueprint itself set for Term 3: **has my direction shifted, and what has the first half of the year taught me about myself?**

Version 1 named three weaknesses: procrastination, overthinking decisions, inconsistent energy levels. My Operating Principles were mostly about willpower — "show up anyway," "do at least 30 minutes," "don't make excuses." The Term 1 revision sharpened that into concrete counter-moves, and the reflection statement landed on a line that's held up since: *"growth isn't about sudden breakthroughs — it's about showing up consistently... discipline matters more than motivation."* That belief has now been tested directly by the sprint work that followed.

What The Sprints Actually Taught Me

IHub Africa PrototypeProject Lead

Discipline showed up as debugging, not motivation

I was project lead and primary code author — navbar links, CSS class mismatches, null-guard errors in JS, unguarded modal event listeners. None of it is exciting work. It's the "show up and do the unglamorous 30 minutes" principle, applied to real code instead of an abstract goal. Structuring those fixes into conventional Git commits and writing the full README was the consistency value in action.

Sprint 5 · Tooling

Overthinking is specifically about tooling, not just decisions

My SWOT named "overthinking decisions" as a general weakness. Sprint 5 revealed a more specific version: when a tool fails (Figma hitting Starter-plan rate limits), the instinct is to wait, retry, or over-plan a workaround. The actual fix was the Term 1 principle applied correctly — limit planning time, switch to Canva Docs as a working fallback, keep moving.

JKRSMM CohortScheduling Deck

Energy management is now a team problem, not just a personal one

The sprint scheduling pitch deck I built to propose shared group session times for the cohort is new territory the original Blueprint didn't anticipate. Version 1's "inconsistent energy levels" was framed entirely as something I manage alone. Proposing structure for five other people (Kamogelo, Mahlatse, Sifiso, Jael, Mukelani) is a different skill than personal daily planning.

GitHub CollaborationUndo Feature

Collaboration tested "respect" and "integrity" directly

Adding an undo feature to a partner's To-Do List repo, navigating collaborator permissions, going through the full branch/PR/review cycle — this is the first time the values table got tested against someone else's codebase and conventions, not my own.

Direction Check · Term 3

Has my direction shifted?

No — but it's gotten more specific, which is the point of revision. Nothing in the sprint work has pushed me away from the Term 1 pathway: employable full-stack developer, open to freelance, long-term interest in independent projects. Leading the iHub Africa prototype — owning architecture decisions, writing documentation, structuring commits for others to follow — is closer to a real junior full-stack role than the Ikigai diagram suggested back in April.

Carrying Forward

Keep the 30-minute rule — the one Operating Principle with direct evidence it works.

Ricardo Ngozo

Updated Good At

Not just "learning quickly" — specifically **diagnosing and repairing broken systems**: code, workflows, or team coordination.

Ricardo Ngozo

New Principle Needed

Current SOPs are solo language ("when I feel X, I do Y"). Need one for when the **team's** coordination is the blocker, not just mine.

Ricardo Ngozo

Tooling Pattern

When a tool breaks, default to the next-best working tool fast (Canva over Figma) rather than waiting it out.

Ricardo Ngozo

Honest Gap — Not Dressed Up

The Term 1 reflection said I'm "becoming someone who doesn't quit when things get hard." The sprint work backs that up for code problems. It hasn't been tested the same way for interpersonal friction inside the team — the GitHub collaboration assignment was cooperative, not conflicted. I don't have evidence yet of how I handle real disagreement on a shared project, and I'd rather flag that gap now than discover it under pressure later in the year.

Reflection Statement · Version 3

I used to think discipline was something I had to summon. This term it became something I just do, because the alternative — an unfinished prototype, a teammate stuck waiting on me, a tool I gave up on too early — was worse than the discomfort of starting. The biggest shift isn't in what I believe about myself; it's that I now have evidence for it. Term 1 was a hypothesis. Term 3 is the first real data.

Update · Term 3 (mid-year): Added this check-in section on top of Version 1 and Version 2. Nothing above this point has been deleted or altered — per the Blueprint's own instruction, this is Version 3, building on what came before it.